# CMT Paddle



Category: **Animal Husbandry & Dairy** Type: **Short SOP** Priority: **Medium** 3 labs

**Covers these lab items:** CMT Paddle; CMT Paddle (for detection of mastitis)

## What it is used for

To screen dairy animals for possible mastitis using a CMT paddle and the approved California Mastitis Test procedure. To identify abnormal milk reactions for further veterinary assessment, not to make a diagnosis alone.

## Main parts

- CMT paddle with separate wells
- Approved CMT reagent
- Milk sample from each quarter
- Sample collection container, if required
- Protective gloves

## Before you start

1. Confirm the test kit instructions and reagent expiry date.
2. Wear clean gloves and use clean equipment.
3. Clean the teats and discard the first streams according to the dairy procedure.
4. Collect a separate sample from each udder quarter into the corresponding paddle well.
5. Avoid mixing samples between quarters.

## How to use

1. Place an appropriate amount of milk in each labelled paddle well.
2. Add the specified amount of CMT reagent to each well according to the kit instructions.
3. Gently swirl the paddle in a circular motion to mix the contents.
4. Observe the mixture within the time window specified by the kit.
5. Compare the reaction with the supplied interpretation guide.
6. Record each quarter's result and identify samples requiring follow-up.
7. Dispose of the mixture and clean the paddle according to the hygiene procedure.

## ⚠ Safety

- Wear gloves and avoid contact with the reagent.
- Do not ingest the reagent or allow it to contact eyes or broken skin.
- Do not use expired or unidentified chemicals.
- Seek veterinary assessment for abnormal results or clinical signs of mastitis.

## Care & storage

- Clean and dry the paddle after use.
- Store the reagent according to its label.
- Keep the kit away from milk containers and feed.
- Replace damaged paddles and expired reagents.

## Common mistakes to avoid

- Mixing milk samples from different udder quarters.
- Using incorrect milk-to-reagent amounts.
- Reading the reaction outside the specified time window.
- Treating a CMT result as a definitive diagnosis without veterinary assessment.

*Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.*



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